

3) Ranking is all important, and SEOs won't lead to a #1 ranking

Let's start with the latter half first. With the correct use of high-quality original content, keywords, and smart backlinking, it is definitely possible. To build or improve your keyword strategy, you need look no further than Google AdWords, which gives great insights into what works and what doesn't. Another good way to improve your ranking is to focus on meta descriptors that you think would attract a large number of viewers.

Now for the fetishisation of ranking. A strong correlation, between result ranks and the traffic that the link gathers, does exist, and to an extent is inevitable. However, recent studies show that ranking is not the king of traffic, as it used to be. With meta descriptions and keywords gaining more prominence, search result ranking has taken a back seat. It has also been shown that users favour the top three listings on the first search page.

What is surprising is that subsequent pages show a similar number of clicks if the entries are at the top end of the page. There are several relevant causes here, chief amongst which is keyword strategy. Without a good strategy, you will end up ranking for irrelevant keywords. Also, attractive meta descriptions are a game changer if they appeal to your target audience.

If you're concerned about Google dismissing meta descriptions entirely when it comes to search rankings, and you would be right to do so. Here, it's important to bring out a crucial distinction between ranking and traffic. So ensure you have an attractive meta description, use the optimum keyword strategy, and stop worrying about the ranking you have.

4) SEO can be automated

We already talked about this when the legitimacy of SEOs was discussed, but it's necessary to go into detail. Such a misconception can cause you to hire a SEO service that will almost certainly defraud you.

One huge reason why SEOs can't be automated is that not all website traffic is the same. Firms that offer an automated, prepackaged SEO service often forget the crucial difference between the experimentation that a rookie does and the pre-tested path that a professional traverses. SEO agencies have to keep tweaking their strategies to continuously convert link visibility into link hits.

Another reason is that without a human element to this optimization, the difference between 'good' links and 'bad' links will remain unidentified. This will lead to the Penguin updates mentioned above simply removing the